

If you haven't already explored all the menus and sub-menus in your distro, do it now! Trial and Error is one of the best ways to learn a GUI. Exploring the layout of your OS is a nice way to start knowing more about what you can do with your system. Most distributions, especially the major ones, have a pretty intuitive interface—the menu system more or less leads you to the shortcut to the application you are looking for, with indicative menu names. If you are looking for OpenOffice.org's Writer, for example, the place to look for would be under the "Office" menu.

We also suggest you read the manual / help files that come with your distribution. When you go to the Help menu, take at least a cursory look at all the topics covered, so you get the basics.

10.1 Information Sources

Linux, we repeat, is community-oriented. There are a lot of resources on the Internet in the form of user groups, forums, articles, white papers and IRC networks. To check on the latest releases and news, check the Web sites of the distributor of your flavour of Linux. Usually, you will find in-depth documentation on the sites—you need to have the patience to read it, but once you do, you will get to know a lot about not only your distro, but Linux in general as well.

At the official Web site, you will also find "Release Notes," which usually contain a list of supported hardware and known issues. Minimum and recommended system requirements are contained in the Release Notes. Usually, with the minimum requirements, the software would just about run: we suggest you treat the *recommended* system requirements as the minimum, and the more you have, the better.

Here is a listing of the official Web sites of the most prominent Linux distributors: